



The Laburnum Top

1. What do you notice about the beginning and the ending of the poem-The Laburnum Top?

Answer: In the beginning of the poem the tree is calm and silent and in the ending it ends with motionless and empty levels.

2. To what is the bird's movement compared? What is the basis for the comparison?

Answer: The goldfinch's movement is compared to that of a lizard. The basis of the comparison is the sleek, abrupt and alert movements of a lizard. The same kinds movements are observed when the goldfinch arrives on the laburnum tree.

3. Why is the image of the engine evoked by the poet?

Answer: The little goldfinch ensures that sustenance is provided to its family so the future generation remains alive. Thus, the bird's behaviour of bringing food to its family has evoked the image of an engine in the poet's mind which similarly provides energy to a machine to keep it running.



4. What do you like most about the poem?

Answer: I like the simple yet beautiful description of the relationship between the tree and bird given in the poem. I like the way the poet has described a very mundane routine of a bird and how it was pouring life in the silent and still laburnum tree.

5. What does the phrase "her barred face identity mask" mean?

Answer: The phrase means that the bird's barred or covered face becomes her identity mask recognition.

6. What is being noticed from the beginning till the end of the poem?

Answer: At the beginning of the poem, the poet talked about a silent laburnum tree that did not make any noise, it was like a lifeless tree. While the ending was similar as well, the poet talked about the goldfinch that flies away into the vast sky.